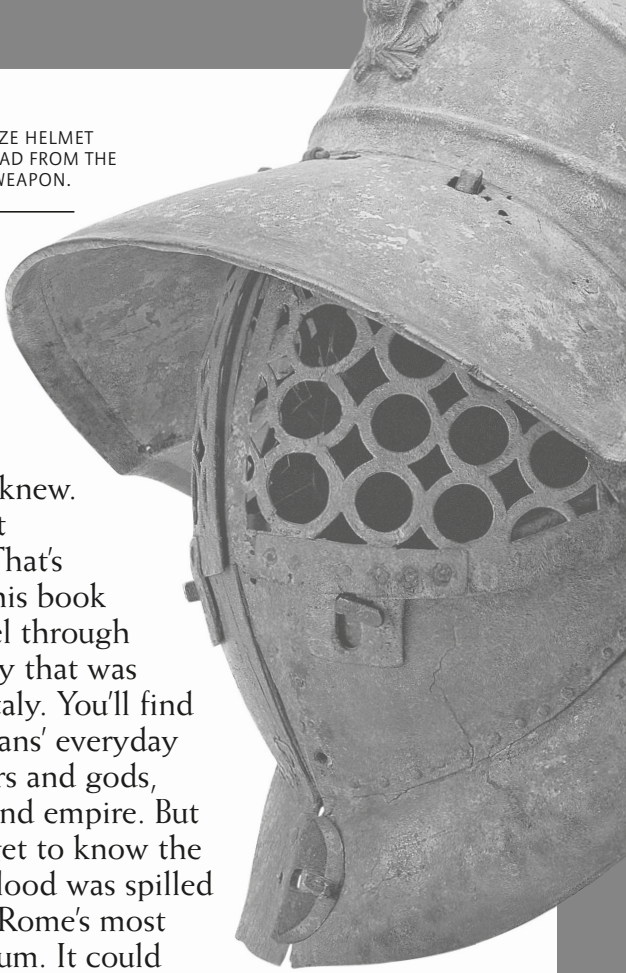


DRESSED TO KILL—THIS BRONZE HELMET
PROTECTED A GLADIATOR'S HEAD FROM THE
BLOWS OF HIS OPPONENT'S WEAPON.

special effects,
or play the latest
computer game,
we can imagine
that we've traveled
back in time to the
world the Romans knew.

But what was that
world really like? That's
where you'll find this book
helpful. You'll travel through
the magnificent city that was
ancient Rome, in Italy. You'll find
out about the Romans' everyday
lives, their emperors and gods,
and their soldiers and empire. But
most of all, you'll get to know the
gladiators whose blood was spilled
in the Colosseum, Rome's most
awe-inspiring stadium. It could
seat 50,000 spectators and might
even be flooded for mock sea battles. Yet it was just
one of more than 230 great amphitheaters that the
Romans built across their empire, from North Africa
to the eastern Mediterranean.

But enough introduction. As the Romans would have
said, "*Mox nox in rem!*"—"Let's get this show on the road!"



John Malcom